If Bekenstein had followed his intuition to its logical conclusion, he would have asserted that somehow a black hole *must* have a finite temperature and *must* emit radiation, and we today would look back on him as an astounding prophet. But Bekenstein waffled. He conceded that it was obvious a black hole cannot radiate, but he clung tenaciously to his faith in black-hole entropy.

Black Holes Radiate

The first hint that black holes, in fact, *can* radiate came from Yakov Borisovich Zel'dovich, in June 1971, fourteen months before the Les Houches summer school. However, nobody was paying any attention, and for this I bear the brunt of the shame since I was Zel'dovich's confidant and foil as he groped toward a radical new insight.

Zel'dovich had brought me to Moscow for my second several-week stint as a member of his research group. On my first stint, two years earlier, he had commandeered for me, in the midst of Moscow's housing crunch, a spacious private apartment on Shabolovka Street, near October Square. While some of my Russian friends shared one-room apartments with their spouses, children, and a set of parents—one *room,* not one bedroom—I had had all to myself an apartment with bedroom, living room, kitchen, television, and elegant china. On this second stint I lived more modestly, in a single room at a hotel owned by the Soviet Academy of Sciences, down the street from my old apartment.

At 6:30 one morning, I was roused from my sleep by a phone call from Zel'dovich. "Come to my flat, Kip! I have a new idea about spinning black holes!" Knowing that coffee, tea, and pirozhki (pastries containing ground beef, fish, cabbage, jam, or eggs) would be waiting, I sloshed cold water on my face, threw on my clothes, grabbed my briefcase, dashed down five flights of stairs into the street, grabbed a crowded trolley, transferred to a trolley bus, and alighted at Number 2B Vorobyevskoye Shosse in the Lenin Hills, 10 kilometers south of the Kremlin. Number 4, next door, was the residence of Alexei Kosygin, the Premier of the U.S.S.R.[6]

I walked through an open gate in the eight-foot-high iron fence and entered a four-acre, forested yard surrounding the massive, squat apartment house Number 2B and its twin Number 2A, with their peeling yellow paint.